Bulletin

Last updated 16-10-2026 at 22:05 — Covering sources published on 16 October 2026

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Spectrum Policy in Africa: Enabling investment and empowering consumers through effective spectrum pricing** — GSMA Intelligence, 16 October 2026 AFRICA

  A GSMA Intelligence study finds African mobile operators held on average 570 MHz of spectrum below 7 GHz at the end of 2025, against 750 MHz elsewhere, and paid 24% more per unit. Only 9 of 54 countries have licences of at least 20 years or a published spectrum roadmap. It estimates pricing and licensing reforms could add more than $120 billion to Africa's GDP between 2026 and 2035. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **Nigeria's Phone Crackdown: Protecting Networks or Pricing Out Everyday Users?** — Tech Africa News, 16 October 2026 NIGERIA

  From 10 October 2026, Nigeria's communications regulator began texting owners of phones not verified under type approval that network access could be blocked after 30 days of active use. The checks run on the NCC's Device Management System against each phone's IMEI, and grey-market and overseas-bought phones are among those flagged. A registration route and official fees had not been clearly published by 16 October. *Also under Access to services*.

- **Morocco appoints Ahmed Rahhou as Minister of Artificial Intelligence, Digital Transformation and Administration Reform** — Tech Review Africa, 16 October 2026 MOROCCO

  King Mohammed VI swore in Ahmed Rahhou on 16 October 2026 as Minister of Artificial Intelligence, Digital Transformation and Administration Reform in Fatima Ezzahra El Mansouri's new government. He replaces Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni, and the new ministry brings AI, digital transformation and administrative reform under one portfolio. *Also under AI and Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **GSMA: Digital Reforms Could Connect 1.12 million More People in Madagascar and Add MGA 4.1 trillion to GDP by 2031** — GSMA, 16 October 2026 MADAGASCAR AFRICA

  A GSMA report launched in Antananarivo says four reforms could bring about 1.13 million more people in Madagascar onto mobile internet and add MGA 4.1 trillion to GDP by 2031: cheaper smartphones through lower levies and duties, a costed rural connectivity plan, lower sector taxes, and voice services in Malagasy. Unique mobile internet penetration was 14.3% in 2025. A companion GSMA report finds spectrum pricing and licensing reform across Africa could add more than US$120 billion to GDP between 2026 and 2035. *Also under Connectivity and Access to services*.

- **EAC Partner States Advance Measure to Strengthen E-Commerce and Digital Trade** — East African Community, 16 October 2026 EAST AFRICA

At a regional e-commerce meeting in Dar es Salaam on 13-15 October 2026, EAC Partner States updated the baseline data in the monitoring tool for the EAC E-Commerce Strategy. They also named priority regional actions on consumer protection, online dispute resolution and readiness for the AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade. *Also under Regional collaboration.*

- **Burundi : une stratégie nationale pour renforcer les capacités de cybersécurité** — We are Tech Africa, 16 October 2026 BURUNDI

  Burundi's Council of Ministers adopted a National Cybersecurity Strategy on 14 October 2026, after work begun by a government commission in 2020 and a World Bank-funded PAFEN consultancy from 2023. The strategy provides for a legal and institutional framework, protection of critical infrastructure and public data, and a national incident-response team. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

- **ATU secures endorsements for 49 African proposals ahead of ITU Plenipotentiary Conference** — TechReviewAfrica, 16 October 2026 AFRICA

  The African Telecommunications Union says all 49 African Common Proposals for the ITU Plenipotentiary Conference in Doha (9-27 November 2026) now have the more than 15 country endorsements each needs, with Ghana making 23 endorsing states. The proposals cover affordable connectivity, cybersecurity, fair access to satellite orbits, AI for development and protection of submarine cables. *Also under Regional collaboration.*

- **Algeria reaches preliminary partnership agreement with Roblox to train video game developers** — Tech Review Africa, 16 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Algeria has reached a preliminary agreement with Roblox on a programme to train Algerian video game developers, announced by Sid Ali Zerrouki. It comes with child-protection conditions: wider parental controls, fast-track reporting channels, and the platform's chat feature kept switched off in Algeria until safeguards are judged sufficient. *Also under Training and skills.*

Legislation and regulation

- **Uganda Champions AU single digital market plan to boost cross-border trade** — Daily Monitor, 16 October 2026 UGANDA

  Ahead of a technology and intellectual property symposium on 22-23 October, Uganda's trade minister set out plans to back the AU's single digital market, including a trust mark for vetted online sellers and rules giving online buyers redress, to be rolled out in the EAC first. A Jumia-led e-commerce industry association and a call for a Consumer Protection Act were also presented. *Also under Regional collaboration.*

- **House Scrutinizes US$52M National ID Deal** — The New Dawn, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Liberia's House of Representatives has sent a proposed US$52 million concession with OeSD International for a national ID and digital civil registry to a joint committee, which has two weeks to report. This account dates the President's communication to plenary on 15 October 2026 and says the build-operate-transfer system would hold demographic and biometric data on up to 10 million people. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Registries.*

- **House Begins Review of Boakai's Proposed National Digital ID Overhaul** — Liberian Observer, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA

Liberia's House of Representatives referred President Boakai's proposed concession with OeSD International for a combined national ID and civil registration system to a joint committee, with 14 days to report; the referral is not ratification. Under the build-operate-transfer deal, OeSD would build and run a system issuing biometric ID numbers and cards and recording births, deaths and marriages, then hand it to the government. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS, Registries and Data protection.*

- **Ghana to host UN convention signing on digital cargo documents on October 26** — MyJoyOnline, 16 October 2026 GHANA

  Ghana will host the signing ceremony for the UN Convention on Negotiable Cargo Documents in Accra on 26 October 2026. The Ghana Shippers' Authority says the convention gives electronic bills of lading and similar documents the legal standing of paper ones, but that the benefits depend on ratification and readiness. *Also under Data Exchange.*

Data protection

- **Murang'a County sues State over patient, hospital system shutdown** — Daily Nation, 16 October 2026 KENYA

  Murang'a County has petitioned Kenya's High Court against the Ministry of Health, the Digital Health Agency, the Health Cabinet Secretary, SHA and the Attorney-General after losing access to its Afya.KE health information system on 14 October 2026. It seeks orders restoring access and protecting clinical records across its more than 176 health facilities while the petition is heard. *Also under Sectoral management information systems and Digitalisation of sub-national government.*

- **Liberia: Naymote Urges Legislature to Tighten US$52M National ID Deal, Cites Cost, Electoral and Data Protection Concerns** — FrontPage Africa, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Liberian civil society group Naymote, in a statement of 15 October 2026, urged the Legislature to tighten the proposed national ID agreement, which it values at US$52 million. It asks for full disclosure of financing, fees and contract terms, an independent value-for-money review, government ownership of identity data, free first-time enrolment and public hearings, and says the electoral commission must keep control of the voters' roll. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

- **Crédits et gestion du risque : l'engagement et la responsabilité des acteurs pour des données fiables au centre de la 8e Rencontre annuelle du BIC-UEMOA** — C'Finance, 16 October 2026 BURKINA FASO WEST AFRICA

  At the 8th annual meeting of the UEMOA credit information bureau, speakers said most microfinance institutions fall outside the duty to report to the bureau: in Burkina Faso, 20 of 120 licensed institutions met the FCFA 2bn threshold at the end of 2025. Panellists called for reporting by all microfinance institutions and wider use of client consent, which a banker said is now required for bureau access across the eight UEMOA states. *Also under Data Exchange.*

- **City Power's electricity theft crackdown faces data problem** — ITWeb South Africa, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Johannesburg utility City Power has put out a tender for near-real-time monitoring of prepaid electricity purchases, aimed at non-technical losses of R3.96bn in 2024/25, or 20.85% of electricity bought. Bidders may propose AI for theft prediction and customer risk scoring, but outputs must be explainable, auditable and compliant with POPIA, with humans making decisions and the data staying City Power's. Experts quoted say prepaid meters show token sales, not consumption, which limits what monitoring can find. *Also under AI, Energy and Digitalisation of sub-national government.*

- **Bold ambitions, fragile foundations: Is Ghana ready for the AI and Data Centre risks it is inviting?** — MyJoyOnline, 16 October 2026 GHANA

  In an opinion piece, cybersecurity and AI governance specialist Victor Awaga asks whether Ghana is ready for the risks of its push into AI and data centres, including the US$250 million AI Computing Centre announced in April 2026. He points to strain on the power grid, thin cybersecurity capacity, and data protection and cyber laws written before generative AI and large data centres. *Also under AI, Data Storage, Energy and Cybersecurity.*

- **House Begins Review of Boakai's Proposed National Digital ID Overhaul** — Liberian Observer, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Regional collaboration

- **World Bank Plans $265M Program To Expand Digital Coverage in Central Africa** — Africa Monitoring, 16 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  The World Bank is preparing CARDIP, a regional digital integration programme for the six CEMAC countries, with an estimated cost of $265.5 million and financing not yet approved. Appraisal is set for 3 November 2026 and board consideration for 12 April 2027, with CEMAC as the implementing body. The first phase would fund broadband and cross-border links in the Central African Republic, Congo, Equatorial Guinea and Gabon, alongside work on ID, payments and data exchange systems. *Also under New investments, Connectivity and Data Exchange.*

- **UBA launches pan-African payment system to ease cross-border transactions** — The Citizen (Mwananchi Communications), 16 October 2026 TANZANIA

  UBA Tanzania has launched cross-border payments over the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System and says it is the first bank in Tanzania to sign up. Its customers can pay into other participating countries from shilling accounts at branches or through WhatsApp and Facebook, for a 2.5% fee capped at US$20, up to US$5,000 a transfer and US$10,000 a day. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **SADC STRENGTHENS REGIONAL CYBERSECURITY AND CYBERCRIME COOPERATION** — SADC, 16 October 2026 ANGOLA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  SADC, AfricaCERT and Angola's telecoms ministry held the seventh SADC Cyber Drill in Luanda on 5-9 October 2026, with 282 delegates testing incident response and cybercrime cooperation. The Secretariat reports that the number of operational national incident-response teams in the region has risen from 4 in 2018 to 13. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

- **Liberia Deepens Cybersecurity Ties With Morocco, Secures Membership In African Digital Security Networks** — FrontPage Africa, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA MOROCCO

  Liberia was admitted to the African Network of Cybersecurity Authorities and SMART Africa, together with Malawi, Lesotho, Mali and Egypt, during Morocco Cyber Security Week in Rabat. Liberia's telecoms minister and the head of Morocco's DGSSI also agreed to pursue a memorandum of understanding on cybersecurity capacity building and technical help. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

- **Ethiopia modernises cross-border payments via PAPSS** — ITWeb Africa, 16 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Ethiopia has joined the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, letting its financial institutions make instant cross-border payments in local currencies with counterparts elsewhere in Africa. The National Bank of Ethiopia reports that digital transaction volumes grew by 146% a year from 2020 to 2025, and the country received $8.2 billion in remittances in 2025/26. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **CRASA and Smart Africa prepare for Regional Roaming Agreements Workshop in Botswana** — TechReviewAfrica, 16 October 2026 SOUTHERN AFRICA

  The Southern African regulators' association CRASA and Smart Africa have met to prepare a workshop in Gaborone on 20-22 October 2026 on implementing sub-regional roaming agreements and the One Africa Network. They also discussed capacity-building work with the Smart Africa Digital Academy. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **Uganda Champions AU single digital market plan to boost cross-border trade** — Daily Monitor, 16 October 2026 UGANDA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **EAC Partner States Advance Measure to Strengthen E-Commerce and Digital Trade** — East African Community, 16 October 2026 EAST AFRICA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **ATU secures endorsements for 49 African proposals ahead of ITU Plenipotentiary Conference** — TechReviewAfrica, 16 October 2026 AFRICA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Standards

- **ISO - SLSB - Sierra Leone Standards Bureau** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  ISO lists the Sierra Leone Standards Bureau as a correspondent member since 2009. As of October 2026 it observes 7 ISO technical committees.

- **ISO - ONANOR - Office National de la Normalisation et det la Métrologie** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026 MAURITANIA

  ISO lists Mauritania's ONANOR as a correspondent member, participating in 5 technical committees and observing 10 as of October 2026. The page's description still names an older directorate under the mines and industry ministry.

- **ISO - NSI - Namibian Standards Institution** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026 NAMIBIA

  ISO lists the Namibian Standards Institution, set up under the Standards Act 2005, as Namibia's member body. As of October 2026 it participates in 21 technical committees and observes 23.

- **ISO - LSI - Lesotho Standards Institution** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026 LESOTHO

  ISO's record for the Lesotho Standards Institution shows it observing 2 ISO technical committees and 3 policy committees, as read in October 2026.

- **ISO - KEBS - Kenya Bureau of Standards** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026 KENYA

  ISO lists the Kenya Bureau of Standards (KEBS), set up under the Standards Act in 1974, as Kenya's member body. It holds one technical committee secretariat, participates in 129 committees and observes 177.

- **ISO - INNORPI - Institut National de la Normalisation et de la Propriété Industrielle** — International Organization for Standardization (ISO), 16 October 2026 TUNISIA

  ISO lists INNORPI, which handles standards, certification and industrial property under Tunisia's industry ministry, as the country's member body. As of October 2026 it participates in 21 technical committees and observes 153.

- **ISO - BBN - Bureau Burundais de Normalisation et Contrôle de la Qualité** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026 BURUNDI

  ISO's member page lists the Bureau Burundais de Normalisation et Contrôle de la Qualité (BBN) as Burundi's member body. As read in October 2026, it participates in 11 ISO technical committees and observes 28.

- **ISO - ANOR - Agence des Normes et de la Qualité** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026 CAMEROON

  ISO lists Cameroon's Agence des Normes et de la Qualité (ANOR) as a member body. As read in October 2026, it participates in 4 technical committees and observes 41.

- **ISO - ACONOQ - Agence Congolaise de Normalisation et de la Qualité** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026 CONGO

  ISO lists ACONOQ, created by a 2015 law, as the Republic of Congo's national standards body and ISO member. It is a member of ARSO and an Affiliate Plus of the IEC, and participates in 2 ISO technical committees.

- **ISO - ABNORM - Agence Burkinabé de Normalisation, de Métrologie et de la Qualité** — International Organization for Standardization, 16 October 2026 BURKINA FASO

  ISO lists ABNORM as Burkina Faso's member body and sole national standards developer. It participates in 9 ISO technical committees and observes 5.

- **International and regional technical committees** — Rwanda Standards Board, 16 October 2026 RWANDA

  The Rwanda Standards Board lists the regional and international technical committees it sits on, including EAC standards committees. Among them, it is a participating member of the ISO/IEC JTC 1 subcommittee on IT service management (SC 40), an observer on JTC 1 and its security subcommittee SC 27, and a member of the EAC committee on IT standards.

- **Coopération Internationale | INNORPI** — INNORPI, 16 October 2026 TUNISIA

  INNORPI's own page sets out its international memberships: it represents Tunisia at ISO and the IEC and belongs to regional standards bodies including ARSO, AIDSMO, SMIIC and AFSEC. The page, which is undated, gives 20 ISO technical committees as a participating member and 148 as an observer.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Liberia: Naymote Urges Legislature to Tighten US$52M National ID Deal, Cites Cost, Electoral and Data Protection Concerns** — FrontPage Africa, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Finance

New investments

- **World Bank Plans $265M Program To Expand Digital Coverage in Central Africa** — Africa Monitoring, 16 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **SoIXP | PCH** — Packet Clearing House, 16 October 2026 SOMALIA

  Packet Clearing House's directory lists the Somali Internet Exchange Point in Mogadishu as active, run by the National Communications Authority and established on 20 November 2018.

- **Ghana Plans 2,800 Telecom Site Builds and Upgrades Nationwide** — Tech Africa News, 16 October 2026 GHANA

  Communications Minister Samuel Nartey George said Ghana will build 800 new cell sites and upgrade 2,000 more within the year across MTN and Telecel networks, with better coverage expected from late 2026 into early 2027. He also said more spectrum had been released in the past two years than in the previous two decades.

- **FG to deploy 3,700 telecom towers to connect 20m Nigerians** — Vanguard, 16 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Communications Minister Bosun Tijani commissioned the first tower of Nigeria's National Universal Communications Access Programme in Bende, Abia State, on 16 October 2026. The programme plans 3,700 towers to reach about 20 million Nigerians without phone or internet service, and the Deputy Speaker named 16 more Bende locations needing coverage. *Also under Digital divides.*

- **Estado da Nação: Presidente destaca progressos nas telecomunicações e transformação digital** — PTI Angola, 16 October 2026 ANGOLA

  In his State of the Nation address, President João Lourenço said Angola added more than 1,300 km of national broadband fibre between 2022 and 2026 and opened free Internet access points in all 18 provinces, reaching about eight million people. He also cited a National Cloud and government data centre, an approved National Cybersecurity Strategy, the World Bank-financed Angola Digital Acceleration Project (PADA), and a UN e-government score of 0.41 in 2024. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov, Data Storage and Cybersecurity.*

- **World Bank Plans $265M Program To Expand Digital Coverage in Central Africa** — Africa Monitoring, 16 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **Spectrum Policy in Africa: Enabling investment and empowering consumers through effective spectrum pricing** — GSMA Intelligence, 16 October 2026 AFRICA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **GSMA: Digital Reforms Could Connect 1.12 million More People in Madagascar and Add MGA 4.1 trillion to GDP by 2031** — GSMA, 16 October 2026 MADAGASCAR AFRICA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **CRASA and Smart Africa prepare for Regional Roaming Agreements Workshop in Botswana** — TechReviewAfrica, 16 October 2026 SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Data Storage

- **Mieux nous connaitre | Orange Business Cameroun — Le Data center Orange Tiers III+** — Orange Business Cameroun, 16 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Orange Business Cameroon describes its data centre, open since May 2017, as Tier III+ with 340 racks in two server rooms. The company claims 99.82% availability and two separate medium-voltage grid feeds; no certification is named. *Also under Energy*.

- **Housing** — Ooredoo Tunisie, 16 October 2026 TUNISIA

  Ooredoo Tunisie offers business hosting in a 188 m2 data centre it describes as built to the TIA-942 standard. Its stated provisions include two independent grid feeds, redundant UPS, generators with 50 hours' autonomy and a 99.95% availability guarantee. *Also under Energy*.

- **Directorate of Financial Management Systems and Technology (DFMST)** — Ministry of Finance, Sierra Leone, 16 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  Sierra Leone's Ministry of Finance set up its Directorate of Financial Management Systems and Technology in 2022 to run the ministry's ICT. The directorate operates a Tier III data centre that hosts ministry systems such as IFMIS and provides co-location for several financial-sector institutions. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Data Center & Colocation – Afcom** — Afcom, 16 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  Afcom describes its Freetown data centre as a privately owned, carrier-neutral Tier III facility offering rack, cage and cloud hosting. It claims 99.9% availability, with redundant generators able to run for two weeks without refuelling.

- **Colocation And Web Hosting Services** — Dalkom Somalia, 16 October 2026 SOMALIA

  Somali operator Dalkom offers colocation and hosting in its own data centres in Mogadishu and Nairobi, connected to a redundant 10 Gbps backbone. The company says it holds stakes in the EASSy cable and WIOCC.

- **Co-Location / Facility Rental Services – GAMTEL** — GAMTEL, 16 October 2026 GAMBIA

  Gambian operator GAMTEL offers ISPs and small businesses space for servers and network equipment at its 43 sites and towers. Its listed prices include a GMD 3,000 installation fee and GMD 1,000 per square metre of floor space a month.

- **Estado da Nação: Presidente destaca progressos nas telecomunicações e transformação digital** — PTI Angola, 16 October 2026 ANGOLA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **Bold ambitions, fragile foundations: Is Ghana ready for the AI and Data Centre risks it is inviting?** — MyJoyOnline, 16 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Energy

- **Mieux nous connaitre | Orange Business Cameroun — Le Data center Orange Tiers III+** — Orange Business Cameroun, 16 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Summarised under Data Storage.

- **Housing** — Ooredoo Tunisie, 16 October 2026 TUNISIA

  Summarised under Data Storage.

- **City Power's electricity theft crackdown faces data problem** — ITWeb South Africa, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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  Summarised under Data protection.

Technical Capacity

- **Le SETIC** — Secrétariat Exécutif des Technologies de l'Information et de la Communication (SETIC), 16 October 2026 BURUNDI

  The home page of Burundi's government ICT secretariat, SETIC, sets out its role coordinating national ICT policy projects. Its listed services for public bodies include software development, cybersecurity, a network operations centre, hosting of national platforms and network maintenance. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

Cybersecurity

- **Gabon Strengthens Cybersecurity Expertise at Octopus 2026 Conference** — Tech Africa News, 16 October 2026 GABON

  A delegation from Gabon's digital infrastructure agency, ANINF, attended the Council of Europe's Octopus 2026 cybercrime conference in Strasbourg on 14-16 October. ANINF says it used the meeting to build expertise on electronic evidence and to look at Gabon joining the Budapest Convention on Cybercrime. *Also under Training and skills*.

- **SADC STRENGTHENS REGIONAL CYBERSECURITY AND CYBERCRIME COOPERATION** — SADC, 16 October 2026 ANGOLA SOUTHERN AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **Liberia Deepens Cybersecurity Ties With Morocco, Secures Membership In African Digital Security Networks** — FrontPage Africa, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA MOROCCO

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **Estado da Nação: Presidente destaca progressos nas telecomunicações e transformação digital** — PTI Angola, 16 October 2026 ANGOLA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **Burundi : une stratégie nationale pour renforcer les capacités de cybersécurité** — We are Tech Africa, 16 October 2026 BURUNDI

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Bold ambitions, fragile foundations: Is Ghana ready for the AI and Data Centre risks it is inviting?** — MyJoyOnline, 16 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Data protection.

DPI

Data Exchange

- **World Bank Plans $265M Program To Expand Digital Coverage in Central Africa** — Africa Monitoring, 16 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **Ghana to host UN convention signing on digital cargo documents on October 26** — MyJoyOnline, 16 October 2026 GHANA

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- **Crédits et gestion du risque : l'engagement et la responsabilité des acteurs pour des données fiables au centre de la 8e Rencontre annuelle du BIC-UEMOA** — C'Finance, 16 October 2026 BURKINA FASO WEST AFRICA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Structure of Vital Statistics Agency | Vital Statistics | Morocco | Civil Registration and Vital Statistics** — CRVS Laws (Global Health Advocacy Incubator), 16 October 2026 MOROCCO

  A legal profile on the CRVS Laws database finds that Morocco's law gives vital statistics roles to the High Commission for Planning, the Interior Ministry and the Health Ministry. Its analysis notes that a 2022 decree lets the Interior Ministry produce statistics from civil status data or share that data with other bodies, but that it neither produces UN-standard vital statistics nor shares the data with the High Commission. *Also under National statistics.*

- **Public services should drive DPI investment, says ID4Africa's Atick** — Biometric Update, 16 October 2026 AFRICA

  In an interview, ID4Africa chairman Joseph Atick argues that digital public infrastructure should be built as the delivery of specific public services demands it, not ahead of use on projected demand. He uses South Africa's social grant payments, which link Home Affairs, SASSA and the Reserve Bank, as his example. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **IPPIS Developer API — api.ippis.rw** — IPPIS Rwanda, 16 October 2026 RWANDA

  Rwanda's public-sector HR platform, IPPIS, offers a REST API through which approved government partner systems can retrieve public servants' NID-verified profiles, education, work history and related records. Access requires partner credentials and bearer tokens. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Individual Taxpayer Registration Form (eForms)** — Revenue Services Lesotho, 16 October 2026 LESOTHO

  Revenue Services Lesotho's online registration form for individual taxpayers asks for the applicant's Lesotho identification number, its expiry date and a copy of the card. A passport or foreign ID can be given instead where the person has one. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Digital identity failures expose Africa's service risks** — ITWeb Africa, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA NIGERIA KENYA AFRICA

  This feature uses earlier incidents to show how identity verification failures can shut people out of several services at once: South Africa's Home Affairs reported failure rates of up to 50% in March 2025, and Nigeria's regulator ordered blocked SIM lines restored in July 2024. Practitioners quoted call for human review, ways to correct records across connected systems, and auditable AI decisions. *Also under Access to services and AI.*

- **Liberia: Naymote Urges Legislature to Tighten US$52M National ID Deal, Cites Cost, Electoral and Data Protection Concerns** — FrontPage Africa, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Summarised under Data protection.

- **House Scrutinizes US$52M National ID Deal** — The New Dawn, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA

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- **House Begins Review of Boakai's Proposed National Digital ID Overhaul** — Liberian Observer, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **The hurdles facing contactless payment adoption across Nigeria** — TechCabal, 16 October 2026 NIGERIA

  This TechCabal feature asks why tap-to-pay has not caught on in Nigeria although electronic payments are widespread, starting from CashAfrica's 13 October rollout of mobile tap-to-pay across more than 350 Chicken Republic outlets. It sets that against earlier attempts such as PayAttitude in 2015 and Access Bank's Tap to Phone in 2025, and against the Lagos transport Cowry card, which works because tapping is built into boarding.

- **Onafriq shuts down its Nigerian agent banking business after five years** — TechCabal, 16 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Onafriq said on 16 October 2026 that it is closing Baxi, its Nigerian agent-banking business, after five years, citing inflation, naira depreciation, rising costs and the growth of instant account-to-account transfers. Baxi agents have been moved to another principal bank, and Onafriq will stay in Nigeria for payments and card issuing. *Also under ICT Industry.*

- **Afrique du Sud : la société financière Wise agréée par la Banque centrale** — wearetech.africa, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  UK money-transfer firm Wise has received category 2 authorisation from the South African Reserve Bank to deal in foreign exchange and send money abroad under regulation. The approval date is not given; Wise already partners with Capitec.

- **UBA launches pan-African payment system to ease cross-border transactions** — The Citizen (Mwananchi Communications), 16 October 2026 TANZANIA

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- **Ethiopia modernises cross-border payments via PAPSS** — ITWeb Africa, 16 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

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Registries

- **House Scrutinizes US$52M National ID Deal** — The New Dawn, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA

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- **House Begins Review of Boakai's Proposed National Digital ID Overhaul** — Liberian Observer, 16 October 2026 LIBERIA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Sectoral management information systems

- **AfyaKE system shutdown: 65,000 patient records at centre of Kang'ata-Duale showdown** — Daily Nation, 16 October 2026 KENYA

  Murang'a Governor Irungu Kang'ata accuses Kenya's national government of switching off the county's AfyaKE hospital system ahead of the 30 October deadline to move to the national Tibabu system, leaving records for about 65,000 patients out of reach and stalling SHA claims. He says the system raised health revenue from Sh80 million to Sh800 million a year; the Ministry of Health says neither the county nor the developers applied for certification. *Also under Digitalisation of sub-national government.*

- **Murang'a County sues State over patient, hospital system shutdown** — Daily Nation, 16 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **La RDC accélère son projet de plateforme intégrée pour les visas électroniques** — wearetech.africa, 16 October 2026 DRC

  DR Congo's digital economy and foreign affairs ministers met on 14 October 2026 to speed up an integrated platform for processing electronic visas. The project is already in the government's 2026-2028 medium-term budget framework and is separate from the migration directorate's existing online visa application portal.

- **Digitalisation : e-Gov Africa mise sur l'IA pour moderniser les services publics** — Le quotidien L'Economie, 16 October 2026 CAMEROON

  At the first e-Gov Africa Summit in Yaoundé, Cameroon's public service ministry reported that its AIGLE staff and payroll platform has processed over 342,049 promotion and tenure acts automatically since January 2025. It cited over 6.4 million logins, over 3 million payslip notifications and secure e-signature in 37 of 40 administrations. *Also under AI.*

- **Public services should drive DPI investment, says ID4Africa's Atick** — Biometric Update, 16 October 2026 AFRICA

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

- **Morocco appoints Ahmed Rahhou as Minister of Artificial Intelligence, Digital Transformation and Administration Reform** — Tech Review Africa, 16 October 2026 MOROCCO

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Le SETIC** — Secrétariat Exécutif des Technologies de l'Information et de la Communication (SETIC), 16 October 2026 BURUNDI

  Summarised under Technical Capacity.

- **IPPIS Developer API — api.ippis.rw** — IPPIS Rwanda, 16 October 2026 RWANDA

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

- **Individual Taxpayer Registration Form (eForms)** — Revenue Services Lesotho, 16 October 2026 LESOTHO

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

- **Estado da Nação: Presidente destaca progressos nas telecomunicações e transformação digital** — PTI Angola, 16 October 2026 ANGOLA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **Directorate of Financial Management Systems and Technology (DFMST)** — Ministry of Finance, Sierra Leone, 16 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  Summarised under Data Storage.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

- **Murang'a County sues State over patient, hospital system shutdown** — Daily Nation, 16 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Data protection.

- **City Power's electricity theft crackdown faces data problem** — ITWeb South Africa, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Data protection.

- **AfyaKE system shutdown: 65,000 patient records at centre of Kang'ata-Duale showdown** — Daily Nation, 16 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Sectoral management information systems.

Technology

AI

- **Demand-led training is one of Africa's biggest challenges – Sand Tech CEO** — Connecting Africa, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  At CollectiveXchange 2026 in Johannesburg, Sand Technologies CEO Fred Swaniker called for training scaled to what employers and the economy need, rather than tied to guaranteed jobs. Communications Minister Solly Malatsi put the digital economy at 7-8% of South Africa's GDP and said it could exceed 15%. *Also under Training and skills and ICT Industry.*

- **Beyond adoption: turning AI productivity into better jobs in African economies** — ODI Global (Overseas Development Institute), 16 October 2026 KENYA AFRICA

  In an ODI Global analysis, Alberto Lemma argues that AI may raise productivity in African firms while cutting the entry-level formal jobs that move workers out of the informal sector. He draws mainly on Kenya, where a World Bank survey estimates 42% of formal firms use some AI and call-centre work has been a first formal job for young people, and calls for targeted demand and training policies. *Also under Training and skills and ICT Industry.*

- **Morocco appoints Ahmed Rahhou as Minister of Artificial Intelligence, Digital Transformation and Administration Reform** — Tech Review Africa, 16 October 2026 MOROCCO

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Digitalisation : e-Gov Africa mise sur l'IA pour moderniser les services publics** — Le quotidien L'Economie, 16 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Summarised under Other GovTech and e-Gov.

- **Digital identity failures expose Africa's service risks** — ITWeb Africa, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA NIGERIA KENYA AFRICA

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

- **City Power's electricity theft crackdown faces data problem** — ITWeb South Africa, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Data protection.

- **Bold ambitions, fragile foundations: Is Ghana ready for the AI and Data Centre risks it is inviting?** — MyJoyOnline, 16 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Data protection.

ICT Industry

- **Onafriq shuts down its Nigerian agent banking business after five years** — TechCabal, 16 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

- **Demand-led training is one of Africa's biggest challenges – Sand Tech CEO** — Connecting Africa, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under AI.

- **Beyond adoption: turning AI productivity into better jobs in African economies** — ODI Global (Overseas Development Institute), 16 October 2026 KENYA AFRICA

  Summarised under AI.

Capacity

Training and skills

- **South Africa's digital jobs drive faces a $152 million funding test** — TechCabal, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  At the CollectiveXChange 2026 summit in Johannesburg on 15 October, The Collective X, which coordinates South Africa's National Digital Skills Plan, reported R600 million mobilised in its Digital Skills Impact Fund and 4,000 beneficiaries so far, against a target of 500,000 young people in digital jobs by 2034. Yellowwoods estimated that reaching 20,000 more by 2028 would take R2.5 billion ($152 million) from existing skills funds, money not yet secured.

- **Gabon Strengthens Cybersecurity Expertise at Octopus 2026 Conference** — Tech Africa News, 16 October 2026 GABON

Summarised under Cybersecurity.

- **Demand-led training is one of Africa's biggest challenges – Sand Tech CEO** — Connecting Africa, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under AI.

- **Beyond adoption: turning AI productivity into better jobs in African economies** — ODI Global (Overseas Development Institute), 16 October 2026 KENYA AFRICA

  Summarised under AI.

- **Algeria reaches preliminary partnership agreement with Roblox to train video game developers** — Tech Review Africa, 16 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Inclusion

Access to services

- **Nigeria's Phone Crackdown: Protecting Networks or Pricing Out Everyday Users?** — Tech Africa News, 16 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **GSMA: Digital Reforms Could Connect 1.12 million More People in Madagascar and Add MGA 4.1 trillion to GDP by 2031** — GSMA, 16 October 2026 MADAGASCAR AFRICA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Digital identity failures expose Africa's service risks** — ITWeb Africa, 16 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA NIGERIA KENYA AFRICA

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

Digital divides

- **FG to deploy 3,700 telecom towers to connect 20m Nigerians** — Vanguard, 16 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Data

National statistics

- **Downloads - GBoS** — Gambia Bureau of Statistics, 16 October 2026 GAMBIA

  The Gambia Bureau of Statistics' downloads page indexes its GDP, price and trade series up to 2025 and its household, health, labour-force and SDG survey reports. Microdata are offered for several surveys, including the DHS and MICS. *Also under Open data.*

- **Structure of Vital Statistics Agency | Vital Statistics | Morocco | Civil Registration and Vital Statistics** — CRVS Laws (Global Health Advocacy Incubator), 16 October 2026 MOROCCO

  Summarised under Digital Identity and CRVS.

Open data

- **Portail National des Données Ouvertes en Tunisie** — Présidence du Gouvernement, Tunisie, 16 October 2026 TUNISIA

  Tunisia's national open data portal lists datasets by theme and publisher, with agriculture the largest theme, and shows nine recorded reuse cases. Its latest news item, from March 2026, is a workshop on the final draft of a national strategy for the governance and opening of public data.

- **Licence de données ouvertes** — INSD, 16 October 2026 BURKINA FASO

  Burkina Faso's national statistics institute, INSD, publishes an open data licence granting free, worldwide, non-exclusive reuse of its data, commercial use included. Users must credit INSD, and the licence is governed by Burkinabè law.

- **Downloads - GBoS** — Gambia Bureau of Statistics, 16 October 2026 GAMBIA

  Summarised under National statistics.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-17**
RETENTION	Kept until 2026-10-24. Older bulletins: the country pages and the monthly reports.
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/bulletin/corpus-bulletin-2026-10-17.pdf
FEEDBACK	info@data-landscapers.io
LICENCE	CC BY 4.0

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